Carl Drechsel

Cloud & AI Transformation Leader | Enterprise Digital Workplace Strategy | Microsoft Ecosystem Architect

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Enterprise AI and Cloud Transformation leader with 20+ years driving technology strategy, customer outcomes, and business value across large enterprise environments. Proven ability to engage executive stakeholders, shape technology strategy, and align Microsoft cloud, security, and AI capabilities to measurable business outcomes and account growth.

Trusted advisor to business and technology leaders, aligning AI, security, and digital workplace transformation initiatives to organizational priorities while driving adoption and long-term value realization.

ACCOUNT STRATEGY & CUSTOMER ENGAGEMENT

- Lead customer-facing digital workplace strategy engagements, aligning technology roadmaps to business priorities and measurable outcomes
- Engage executive stakeholders (CIO, CISO, and business leaders) to define AI, security, and digital transformation strategies
- Influence cross-functional virtual teams across architecture, engineering, and sales to deliver aligned customer outcomes

STRATEGY & AI WORKFORCE EXPERTISE

AI adoption, Copilot enablement, and business value realization • AI use case development and value articulation • Technology strategy and operating model alignment • Executive advisory & stakeholder engagement • Change management & adoption strategy • Cross-functional leadership and delivery alignment

Microsoft 365 & Copilot platforms • Azure cloud architecture • Identity architecture & Zero Trust • Enterprise collaboration platforms • Compliance & governance • AI and Security strategy alignment

ENTERPRISE AI ENABLEMENT

Lead enterprise AI enablement initiatives across Microsoft 365 and Azure, translating emerging AI capabilities into scalable solutions that improve productivity, decision-making, and collaboration.

- Designed AI readiness strategies aligned to enterprise architecture, identity, governance, and Microsoft 365 platforms including Copilot
- Identified knowledge work inefficiencies and defined AI-enabled use cases to improve productivity and operational outcomes
- Advise enterprise leaders on AI adoption, governance, and value realization, aligning initiatives to measurable business impact

AI PRODUCT DEVELOPMENT | SalesInsight — AI Sales Intelligence Platform (Founder / Architect)

Led the design and development of an applied AI platform that transforms unstructured sales conversations into structured intelligence used for deal strategy, opportunity analysis, and proposal development.

- Designed structured Sales Intelligence Briefs that convert conversation data into strategic deal and execution insights
- Built a workflow architecture combining LLM-based analysis, structured output models, and automation to accelerate proposal generation and opportunity alignment
- Demonstrates applied use of AI to enhance enterprise knowledge workflows, decision clarity, and execution outcomes

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Global Technology Consulting Firm | **Senior Solutions Architect - Enterprise AI Enablement & Digital Workplace** | *July 2022 – Present*

Lead customer-facing cloud and digital workplace strategy engagements, partnering with enterprise stakeholders to align Microsoft technologies to business outcomes, drive adoption, and support account growth.

- Drive execution across enterprise engagements while aligning stakeholders to strategic priorities and ensuring successful business outcomes
- Engage executive stakeholders to define digital workplace strategies aligned to business priorities and measurable outcomes
- Lead AI-enabled workforce transformation engagements, guiding customers from readiness through adoption, use case development, and value realization
- Identify and shape new opportunities by aligning Microsoft AI and cloud capabilities to customer needs, supporting expansion and long-term value realization
- Influence cross-functional teams across delivery, sales, and partner organizations to achieve aligned customer outcomes
- Deliver strategic technology guidance across AI, security, and cloud solution areas, aligning Microsoft capabilities to customer business priorities and long-term transformation goals
- Act as a trusted advisor to enterprise stakeholders, guiding technology decisions through industry context, architectural insight, and business alignment

Key Strategic Engagements:

Global Investment Firm – Enterprise EUX Transformation Strategy

- Led enterprise EUX transformation aligned to business priorities, introducing AI and Copilot use cases to support workforce productivity and decision-making

Regional Healthcare System – Microsoft 365 Tenant Consolidation

- Delivered unified collaboration strategy aligned to business priorities, improving operational efficiency and cross-organization productivity

Global Insurance Provider – Security & Risk Governance

- Defined security and compliance strategy leveraging Microsoft 365 capabilities to support regulatory outcomes

Large U.S. Financial Institution – Teams Compliance Architecture

- Enabled regulatory compliance through architecture design supporting retention, supervision, and policy enforcement

National Healthcare Organization – Security & Compliance Assessment

- Delivered risk assessment and prioritized roadmap aligning identity and data protection strategies to business requirements

Global Technology Consulting Firm | **Senior Solutions Architect - Microsoft Security & Modern Workplace |** *August 2021 – July 2022*

Recruited to lead the development of Microsoft security consulting capabilities within the consulting services organization, establishing service offerings, shaping go-to-market strategy, and supporting early-stage customer engagements.

- Led the build-out of Microsoft security consulting services, defining offerings aligned to Microsoft 365 security, compliance, and identity solutions
- Partnered with sales and leadership to shape engagements and drive early adoption, translating customer requirements into scoped solutions and delivery approaches
- Contributed to go-to-market strategy and positioned Microsoft security capabilities within enterprise accounts to drive consulting opportunities

Regional Financial Institution | **Enterprise Architect III, AVP — Enterprise Infrastructure (End User Services)** | *September 2019 – August 2021*

Domain architect responsible for modern workplace strategy across collaboration platforms, identity architecture, and workforce productivity services.

Defined enterprise technology direction supporting secure, scalable digital workplace services for a large financial services environment.

- Led early Azure adoption strategy, establishing foundational cloud direction aligned to identity, security, and enterprise workloads
- **Cost Optimization:** Directed Microsoft licensing strategy generating **$5M in savings** through persona-based optimization.
- **Modernization:** Developed Zero Trust identity blueprint and virtual desktop strategy for cloud-delivered workspaces.
- **Governance:** Led architecture governance for enterprise migration to Microsoft 365.

Regional Financial Institution | **Technical Engineer IV, Bank Officer |***December 2015 – September 2019*

Led technical architecture and delivery for enterprise collaboration modernization initiatives.

- Led enterprise Office 365 deployment enabling secure modern collaboration.
- Designed Azure AD Connect & Conditional Access supporting identity-as-a-service.
- Implemented MFA and governance controls supporting 20,000+ users.

Global Managed Service Provider (Industrial Sector Client) | **Senior Messaging Engineer** | *October 2012 – December 2015*

- Migrated 120,000 mailboxes across global environment.

Enterprise Software Company | **Senior Technical Product Manager |** *January 2011 – October 2012*

- Defined product strategy and architecture for Microsoft Exchange and SharePoint monitoring solutions - Speaker at Microsoft Tech-Ed North America 2012

Global Enterprise Services Organization | **Senior Global Messaging & Collaboration Engineer** | *September 2006 – December 2010*

- Consolidated 82 global email systems into a unified architecture for 100,000 users.

CERTIFICATIONS - Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900) • Microsoft 365 Certified: Security Administrator Associate *(expired)*

EDUCATION - MBA, SUNY Buffalo • BS, Management & Marketing, Canisius College • AAS, Business Administration, Erie Community College